

Codebook: How to Annotate Generational Claims

Unit: One row = Parent Comment (The Claim) + Reply (The Reaction).

Goal: We are looking for how people talk about generations (stereotypes) and how others respond.

0) Include or Exclude?

The Golden Rule: We want to capture *every* valid stereotype, even if the reply goes off-topic. You can follow this 2-step check:

Step 1: The Parent Check (Is there a claim?) Look at the **Parent Comment**. (*Note: If the Comment is empty or useless, look at the **Post Title** or **Selftext** instead*).

- **Does it mention a generation (Boomers, Gen X, Millennials, Gen Z) AND assign them a trait, behavior, or habit?**
 - **YES: INCLUDE the row.** Proceed to Step 2.
 - **NO: EXCLUDE the row.** (Reason: "Off-topic," "Deleted," "Link only," or "Quote only")

Step 2: The Reply Check (Is the reaction relevant?) Now look at the **Reply**.

- **Does the Reply talk about the generation or the claim?**
 - **YES:** Annotate the **Stance** (Support/Oppose) and **Counter-moves** normally.
 - **NO (Topic Drift):** If they start talking about car parts, recipes, or specific celebrities without linking it back to the generation:
 - Set **Stance** to Neutral/Off-topic.
 - Leave **Counter-moves** blank.
 - *We still keep the row because the Parent data is good!*

1) The Context (Who is talking?)

- **Perspective:**
 - **Auto:** The author is part of the group ("As a Millennial, we are tired...").
 - **Hetero:** The author is talking about a different group ("Gen Z is glued to their phones").
 - **Mixed:** Unclear or "We vs. Them" without saying who "We" is.
- **Targets:** List the generation(s) being discussed (genz; boomer; genx; millennial).

2) The Parent Comment (The Claim)

A. The Core Meaning

- **Generic vs. Specific:**
 - **Generic:** Talking about the group as a whole ("Most Boomers are...", "Gen Z tends to...").
 - **Specific:** Talking about one specific person or event ("My dad yelled at a waiter").
- **Valence:** Is it **Positive**, **Negative**, or **Mixed**? (Factual definitions are **Neutral**).
- **Warmth:** Is the group described as kind/friendly? (0 = No, 1 = Yes).
- **Competence:** Is the group described as smart/capable? (0 = No, 1 = Yes).
- **Frame (Topic):** Pick the main topic.

- *Work/Economy, Wealth/Housing, Tech/Media, Politics, Education, Health/Aging, Family, Environment, Identity (defining the generation).*

B. Packaging (Language Style)

- **Group Noun:** Uses the name as a noun? ("Boomers").
- **Adjective Label:** Uses it as a descriptor? ("Boomerish behavior").
- **Quantifier:** Does it say how *many* people? If yes, pick a bucket:
 - **Universal:** all, every, always, never.
 - **Majority:** most, usually, typically, generally.
 - **Existential:** many, some, few, several.
 - **Frequency:** often, sometimes, rarely.
- **Negation:** Uses "not," "don't," "won't," "can't"? (0/1).
- **Hedge:** Does the author sound unsure? If yes, pick a bucket:
 - **Opinion/Guess (Epistemic):** I think, maybe, perhaps, IMO.
 - **Appearance:** seems, looks like, appears.
 - **Possibility (Modal):** might, could, probably, likely.
- **Booster:** Does the author sound extra sure? If yes, pick a bucket:
 - **Emphatic:** definitely, absolutely, clearly, literally, no doubt.

C. Nature of the Claim

- **Abstraction:**
 - **Trait:** A permanent quality (lazy, smart, entitled).
 - **Event:** A specific action (didn't tip, voted for X).
- **Severity:**
 - **0 (Civil):** Normal criticism or observation.
 - **1 (Insulting):** Name-calling ("Idiots", "Jerks").
 - **2 (Dehumanizing):** Hate speech, calling them animals/vermin, wishing harm/death.

3) The Reply (The Reaction)

A. Stance

- **Support:** Agrees with the generational claim ("Exactly," "So true").
- **Mitigate:** Agrees but softens/qualifies it ("True, but not *all* of us," "Some do, sure").
- **Oppose:** Disagrees, refutes, or mocks the claim ("That's a lie," "Wrong," "Ok Boomer").
- **Neutral / Off-topic:**
 - The reply is asking a question ("Source?").
 - **Topic Drift:** The reply completely ignores the generation and starts talking about something else (e.g., car parts, recipes, specific celebrities, movie plots).
 - *Note:* If you mark this, leave "Counter-moves" blank.

B. Counter-Moves (Tick all that apply) (*Only fill this if Stance is NOT Neutral/Off-topic*)

- **"Not All":** "Not all Boomers do that!"
- **Counter-example:** Shares a personal story that disproves the claim.

- **Evidence Challenge:** Asks for source, stats, or proof.
- **Alternative Cause:** "It's not their age, it's the economy/lead poisoning."
- **Reframing:** "Don't judge," appealing to morals or empathy.

C. New Claims in Reply

- **Reply makes its own claim? (0/1):** Does the reply create a *new* stereotype?
 - If Yes: Fill out the **Packaging** fields (Quantifier, Hedge, Booster) for the Reply text.

4) Cheat Sheet (Tie-Breakers & Edge Cases)

- The "Rescue" Rule (Link-Only or Empty Parents):**
 - If the **Parent Comment** is just a link, a quote, deleted, or says "Wow," **check the Post Title or Selftext.**
 - If the Title/Selftext contains a stereotype, **annotate THAT as the Parent.** Do not exclude the row
- The "Topic Drift" Rule:**
 - If the Parent says "Millennials are broke," but the Reply says "I like the new Honda Civic," **keep the row.**
 - Annotate the Parent normally.
 - Mark the Reply Stance as **Neutral/Off-topic.**
- Generic vs. Specific:**
 - **Generic:** Any clue they mean the group ("They," "Most," "Boomers," "People these days").
 - **Specific:** A story about *one specific person* without generalizing ("My dad," "This guy").
- Implicit "They" (Context is King):**
 - If the Post Title says "Boomers being fools" and the comment just says "They are so dumb," **include it.**
 - "They" = Boomers because of the context.
- "Usually" Rule:**
 - "Boomers **usually** ignore facts" = **Majority** Quantifier (Most Boomers).
 - "It **usually** happens at night" = **Frequency** Quantifier (How often).
- Multiple Quantifiers:**
 - Pick the one that modifies the main group.
 - "Some Boomers are crazy" → **Existential** ("Some").
 - "Boomers are **always** crazy" → **Universal** ("Always").
- Irony & Sarcasm:**
 - If a Reply quotes a stereotype just to make fun of it (e.g., "Oh sure, because *avocado toast* is the problem"), mark Stance as **Oppose.**